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National Strategy for Financial Inclusion in Curaçao

2024 – 2028

Issued jointly by the Ministry of Finance and the Central Bank of Curaçao and Sint Maarten

Reference: FIS-2024-001 | Sample document

1. Foreword

Financial inclusion is a precondition for inclusive economic growth and decent work, the twin ambitions of Sustainable Development Goal 8. Adults who hold an account at a regulated financial institution or with a mobile-money-service provider are better placed to absorb economic shocks, save for productive investments, and participate in the formal economy. This strategy sets out the actions Curaçao will take between 2024 and 2028 to expand access to financial services for all residents.

2. The case for financial inclusion in Curaçao

While Curaçao's banking sector is well developed by regional standards, account ownership is not uniformly distributed across age groups, income deciles, or migrant status. Persistent gaps create barriers to formal employment, social-protection transfers, and remittance flows. Closing these gaps directly supports indicator 8.10.2 of the Sustainable Development Goals.

3. Strategic objectives

The strategy is organised around four pillars, each with measurable targets to be tracked annually by the Central Bureau of Statistics:

- **Access.** Expand the network of access points (branches, agents, ATMs, and digital channels) so that no resident is more than 30 minutes from a regulated service point.
- **Usage.** Increase the share of adults using their account at least monthly to receive wages, make payments, or save.
- **Quality.** Strengthen consumer protection, transparency of fees, and complaint-resolution mechanisms across all licensed providers.
- **Digital readiness.** Develop a regulatory framework for mobile-money and electronic-money providers, including interoperability requirements.

4. Linkage to SDG 8.10

The strategy is explicitly aligned with target 8.10 of the 2030 Agenda, which calls on member states to “strengthen the capacity of domestic financial institutions to encourage and expand access to banking, insurance and financial services for all”. Progress will be reported through indicator 8.10.2 on the national SDG platform.

5. Implementation and review

Implementation will be coordinated by the Financial Inclusion Steering Group, chaired by the Ministry of Finance and including representatives of the Central Bank, the Central Bureau of Statistics, the licensed banks and credit institutions, the consumer-protection authority, and civil society. An annual progress note will be published alongside the updated SDG 8.10.2 data point.